

JACK SENECHAL

ENGINEERING MANAGER

Located in Novato, CA

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SUMMARY

- **Engineering manager** with **15+ years** in software development and **6+ years building and leading teams** across multiple product domains
- Recruited, coached, and grew high-performing teams from scratch, elevating junior engineers to senior technical and engineering management positions
- Drove organization-wide DevOps culture transformation, influencing decisions at all levels and promoting best practices across engineering
- Strong cross-functional collaborator, partnering with product, design, and stakeholders to align roadmaps and deliver business impact
- Hands-on technical leader who stays deep in architecture, code review, and implementation alongside management responsibilities
- Entrepreneurial mindset with multiple co-founding experiences and a focus on shipping high-quality software

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Independent Consultant · AI-Native Software Delivery

Client engagements | May 2026 - Present | Remote

- **Run “software factories”:** agent-driven delivery pipelines that carry engineering work from spec to shipped, with the human in the product seat. Persistent orchestrating agent sessions delegate implementation to cheaper-model subagents, each isolated in its own git worktree with its own database, so parallel work cannot collide.
- **Core thesis, proven in production:** the same DevOps and project-management discipline that makes human teams work is also the necessary and sufficient foundation for agent teams, encoded into the harness and context instead of taught to people.
- **Built the coordination substrate on GitHub itself:** issues, PRs, and Projects as the single ledger, kept honest by scheduled automation that derives board state from PR, CI, and label reality rather than trusting agents to remember to update it.
- **Enforce the SDLC in the harness rather than by instruction:** every PR gated by an independent fresh-context reviewer agent and by branch protection (green CI, supply-chain scanning, deployment smoke check). **The harness has begun improving itself**, with the Architect and Team Lead agents (running on different frontier models) converging independently on process refinements and shipping them. The session lifecycle hook that blocks an agent from ending with dispatched work uncommitted was theirs, built after they observed the failure.
- **Own the product role by design:** define and prioritize the work, verify against deployed previews before anything ships, and steer how tight the human-in-the-loop gates run.

Co-founder & Fractional CTO

Building Humane Technology | June 2025 - Present | Remote

- Co-architecting and leading development of **HumaneBench.ai**, an open-source AI evaluation framework built on AISI Inspect. Python.
- Driving product and technical roadmap including production monitoring, multi-turn evaluation, and maturity models to guide AI tool adoption across teams.
- Coordinating open-source community engagement, hackathons, and education initiatives.

Co-founder & Software Engineer

Alchemy Astrology (formerly Mirror Astrology) | Nov 2024 - Jul 2026 | Remote

- Owned front-end development: Ruby on Rails views, JavaScript, HTML+CSS, Tailwind, responsive UI/UX.
- Led design and UX delivery, working with freelance designers and translating their designs into the Rails framework.

- Collaborated on back-end development: Stripe integration, SSO authentication, Rails MVC.
- Collaborated closely with co-founders on product direction, Figma design, UX, roadmap planning, and prioritization.

Infrastructure Engineer

Tobiko | Mar 2024 - Oct 2024 | Remote

- Architected and implemented a scalable cloud platform serving customer workloads at a fast-paced startup.
- Built CI/CD patterns including mono-repo conditional workflows, workload identity federation, and continuous delivery.
- Implemented a Slack-based customer support and incident response platform; onboarded teammates and customers.
- Python, Pulumi, GCP, GKE, Cloud Run, CircleCI, Helm, SQLMesh.

Engineering Manager / Principal Software Engineer

Mavenlink / Kantata | Apr 2017 - Dec 2023 | San Francisco, CA

- **M-Bridge Integration Platform** (2 years): Led a team to stabilize and scale an agent-based integration platform handling multi-system data orchestration. Established operational metrics and monitoring that reduced errors and incidents by ~100x. Executed a zero-downtime migration to Kubernetes including relational, document, and cache databases.
- **Infrastructure Platform** (4 years): Recruited and built a new team from scratch dedicated to the infrastructure platform. Led the organization's DevOps culture transformation, serving as a change agent and technical authority across engineering. Created a clear, calm, and constructive environment that allowed the team to thrive. Owned roadmap stewardship, requirements triage, and priority management while staying hands-on with coding, architecture, and code review. Transitioned a large legacy codebase to cloud-native, Infrastructure-as-Code tooling (Terraform, Ansible, Kubernetes).
- **BI Data Pipeline** (3 months): Led a transition team to take ownership of and improve the analytics data pipeline. Migrated the pipeline to Kubernetes.
- **Cross-Functional Impact:** Grew multiple junior engineers into senior SWE and Engineering Manager roles, and mentored engineers across teams. Led interviewing and hiring. Drove organizational change management and process optimization. **Top Performer Award, 2021.**

Lead Developer, Co-founder

Pegg | 2014 - 2017 | San Francisco, CA

- Designed, architected, and built a cross-platform mobile app from scratch (iOS/Android). Node.js backend, JS/Phonegap frontend, Firebase real-time systems, CI/CD to AWS/CloudFront via CircleCI.
- Established engineering workflow: pair programming, automated testing (Karma/Chai), continuous integration, and rapid deployment processes.
- Co-led product strategy, monetization, and launch planning.

Earlier Career (2001 - 2014)

- **Consultant & Entrepreneur** (2008 - 2014): Founded OpenTest Pro (automated testing education). Built e-commerce ordering system for Turnbull & Asser shirtmakers. Full-stack consulting in Ruby on Rails, Node.js, D3 data visualization. Rapid prototyping and client delivery.
- **Web Developer, OnForce, Inc** (2006 - 2007): Introduced automated testing and CI. Built comprehensive API test suite. Integrated platform with Salesforce APIs.
- **Development Lead, JBA Network** (2003 - 2006): Lead programmer and project manager for mynewsletterbuilder.com. Architected the initial release, then built and scaled the development team.

OPEN SOURCE PROJECTS

Scan MCP (2024 - Present)

MCP (Model Context Protocol) server for scanner automation and document digitization. Privacy-first architecture with smart device discovery, JSON Schema validation, and support for both local stdio and network HTTP transports. TypeScript/Node.js.

github.com/jacksenechal/scan-mcp

HumaneBench (2024 - Present)

Evaluation framework for measuring human-friendly behavior in AI assistants, built on AISI Inspect. Tests AI responses across humane technology principles including loneliness, mental health, transparency, and privacy. Supports multiple LLM providers with extensible scenario datasets. Python.

github.com/buildinghumanetech/humanebench

SKILLS

- **Languages & Frameworks:** JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, Ruby on Rails, Node.js, Bash.
- **Front-end:** React, Vue, HTML, CSS, Tailwind, Responsive Design, UI/UX.
- **Back-end & Data:** API Design, Microservices, Distributed Systems, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis.
- **Cloud & Infrastructure:** AWS, Google Cloud Platform, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, Ansible, Pulumi, Helm.
- **CI/CD & DevOps:** CircleCI, GitHub Actions, Automated Testing, TDD, Infrastructure as Code, Cloud-Native Architecture.
- **AI/LLM:** MCP (Model Context Protocol), chatbot development, prompt engineering, tool use, context augmentation.
- **Leadership:** Team Building, Coaching & Mentoring, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Roadmap Ownership, Hiring, Agile/Scrum/Kanban, Change Management.

EDUCATION

BA in Mathematics, minor in Computer Science

University of North Carolina at Asheville | May 2003

- Graduated with distinction in Mathematics. Undergraduate research in 4D fractals.

RECOMMENDATIONS

“Jack is **an exceptional engineer and leader**. He strives to **deeply understand the technology** he’s working on while remaining cognizant of the socio-technical components that may be a factor in any project. He’s thorough, detail-oriented, and outcome-oriented, which means **the solutions he architects, builds, and collaborates on come out better**. Jack also strives to be at the forefront of new technology and assess how he can leverage it. He does all this with a **strong team mentality**, is a phenomenal team player, and can **effectively delegate to help lift others’ skill sets**.”

— *Brandon Clifford, Director of DevOps, Kantata*

“Jack has **had quite a profound impact on my career**. As a young engineer, I was fortunate enough to work with Jack as my coach. He served as a great mentor, helping me build both technical and professional skills and **forming me into the engineer that I am today**. **His mentorship was a key factor in elevating me from an incoming Junior Engineer to an Engineering Manager**. Jack has a great curiosity and a strong set of technical capabilities that allow him to serve as a great example for others and a key contributor to any team!”

— *Wesley Morlock, Engineering Manager, Kantata*

“Jack is a fantastic engineer always ready to **help solve problems and more importantly, teach you how to solve them**. He guided me and my team through a bunch of challenging GitOps situations with patience and kindness, leading by example. Always diligent with his work, willing to roll up his sleeves to get things done and **find creative solutions**. Everyone would be lucky to have someone like him in their teams!”

— *Cesar Palafox Garza, Principal Software Engineer, Kantata*

“Jack is **awesome at understanding the direction teams need to go to make important improvements in Kantata’s Engineering organization as a whole**. He has been instrumental in building and implementing strategies to upgrade Ruby, Rails, and React. If I had any questions about infrastructure and Kubernetes he would be able to answer and **provide solid explanations to the entire team**.”

— *Justin Hurstwright, Principal Software Engineer, Kantata*

See additional recommendations on LinkedIn

The latest version of this document can be found at <http://jacksenechal.com/resume>